Le Pen's determined stance against further mass immigration, and sharp disapproval of efforts to appease Islamists does have some potential appeal to Jews, though far less than for those French voters who for years have felt ignored by their governing elites.

Since the year 2000, there have been over 8,000 antisemitic incidents in France—figures that include only those cases actually reported to the police—which account at best for some 40% of the real numbers. This situation helps to explain why close to half of Jews in France, Belgium, and Hungary have contemplated emigration in recent years. With regard to France, it was anticipaated, even before the Gaza war, that more than 5,000 Jews would make *aliyah* to Israel in 2014, and indeed the actual figures were a record for French Jews since the foundation of the Jewish State. In 2015, the *aliyah* numbers are likely to be at least twice as high. This prompted Christophe Barbier, the leading editorialist and publisher of the center-left magazine *L'Express* to accuse French Jews in early August 2014 of "bunkerization," betraying republican values, and supporting the far Right in both France and Israel. Jews who deserted France for Israel, he charged, were in effect "cowards."[14] Since Barbier probably considers himself a "friend" of French Jews, such remarks reveal the tensions only just beneath the surface.

There is no doubt that the increasing infiltration of antisemitism—both Middle Eastern and European—reached a new fever pitch as a result of the Gaza war. When a Turkish café owner in Liège, Belgium feels able to put up a sign worthy of Nazi Germany, announcing "Dogs welcome but not Jews," an evil wind is surely blowing; when a Flemish doctor in Antwerp rebuffs a 90-year-old Jewish woman's request for medical treatment by telling her to go to Gaza; or when South Asian youths scream "Heil Hitler!" at Jewish pedestrians in an Orthodox neighborhood of Manchester, the loosening of residual taboos concerning antisemitism has become all-too-apparent.[15] In Britain, antisemitic incidents in July 2014 reached an all-time high though they were notably less violent than in France. For the entire year, more than 1,000 instances of antisemitism were recorded in Great Britain, providing serious questions about the future of Jews in the country.

Operation Protective Edge, even more than its predecessors in 2009 and 2012, seems to have encouraged a fierce flood of vitriol against Israel and its Jewish supporters. The demonization of Tsahal (Israel Defense Forces) as an army of child-murderers was general rampant along with nauseous slogans about israel as a "terrorist state" inflicting "genocide" on totally "innocent" Palestinians. The demonstrations of support for Hamas treated it as a heroic movement of resistance to oppression and totally ignored its many war

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,